

Wheat (Cereal Crop) in Madhya Pradesh

1. Introduction

- Wheat is the **main Rabi cereal crop** of Madhya Pradesh.
 - It is the **second most important food grain crop after rice** in the state.
 - MP is known as the “**Wheat Bowl of India**” due to its large production and high quality wheat (especially *Sharbati Wheat*).
 - Wheat is mainly used for making chapati, bread, biscuits, pasta, and other food products.
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2. Classification

- **Kingdom:** Plantae
 - **Family:** Poaceae (Grass family)
 - **Genus:** Triticum
 - **Species:** *Triticum aestivum* (Common bread wheat — mostly grown in MP)
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3. Major Wheat-Growing Districts in MP

Wheat is cultivated throughout MP, but the **major producing regions** are:

- **Malwa and Nimar Plateau:** Indore, Ujjain, Dewas, Dhar, Shajapur, Sehore, Ratlam
 - **Central MP:** Hoshangabad (Narmadapuram), Bhopal, Vidisha, Raisen, Sagar
 - **Northern MP:** Gwalior, Morena, Bhind, Shivpuri, Datia
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4. Soil and Climate Requirements

Factor	Requirement
Soil Type	Fertile alluvial and black cotton soil (deep loam, well-drained)
Soil pH	6.0 – 7.5
Temperature	20°C–25°C during growth, 25°C–30°C at maturity
Rainfall	75–100 cm annually

Factor	Requirement
Season	Rabi (sown in October–November, harvested in March–April)

5. Important Varieties of Wheat in MP

Type	Common Varieties	Features
Sharbati Wheat (Malwa region)	<i>Sharbati, Lok-1, HI-1544, HI-1531</i>	High protein, soft texture, golden grains
Other Improved Varieties	<i>GW-273, HI-8498 (Malav Shakti), HD-2967, JW-3020</i>	Drought-resistant, high yield

6. Cultivation Practices

1. **Land Preparation:** 2–3 ploughings followed by leveling.
 2. **Sowing Time:** October to November (Rabi season).
 3. **Seed Rate:** 100–125 kg/ha.
 4. **Method:** Drilling or broadcasting.
 5. **Irrigation:**
 - First irrigation after 20–25 days of sowing (Crown root initiation stage).
 - Total 4–6 irrigations as per soil condition.
 6. **Fertilizers:**
 - NPK (120:60:40 kg/ha).
 - Organic manure for soil enrichment.
 7. **Weed Control:** Manual weeding or herbicides.
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7. Harvesting and Yield

- **Harvesting:** Done when grains become hard and golden.
 - **Harvesting Period:** March–April.
 - **Yield:**
 - Normal varieties: 3–4 tons/ha
 - High-yield varieties: up to 5–6 tons/ha
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8. Uses

1. **Food Uses:** Flour (atta), bread, biscuits, noodles, pasta.
 2. **Industrial Uses:** Alcohol, starch, gluten, animal feed.
 3. **Export:** MP’s “Sharbati Wheat” is exported due to its premium quality.
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9. Advantages of Wheat Cultivation in MP

- ☐ Suitable climate and fertile black soil.
 - ☐ High yield potential (especially in irrigated areas).
 - ☐ Major source of farmer income in Rabi season.
 - ☐ National and international demand for *Sharbati Wheat*.
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10. Challenges / Problems

- ☐ Dependence on irrigation (less rainfall in Rabi).
 - ☐ Attack of rust disease and termites.
 - ☐ Price fluctuations in the market.
 - ☐ Water scarcity in western MP regions.
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11. Fun & Economic Facts

- Madhya Pradesh is India’s **largest producer of wheat**, contributing around **20% of national production**.
 - **Sharbati Wheat** of the Malwa region is called “**Golden Wheat**” due to its shine and softness.
 - MP exports wheat to **Gulf and European countries**.
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☐ Summary Table: Wheat in Madhya Pradesh

Parameter	Details
Crop Type	Rabi (Cereal Crop)
Scientific Name	<i>Triticum aestivum</i>
Sowing Time	October–November

Parameter	Details
Harvesting Time	March–April
Soil Type	Black cotton & alluvial soils
Temperature	20–25°C
Rainfall	75–100 cm
Major Districts	Indore, Ujjain, Sehore, Hoshangabad, Vidisha, Gwalior
Varieties	Sharbati, Lok-1, HI-1544, HD-2967
Yield	3–6 tons/ha
Special Feature	High-quality “Sharbati Wheat”
Main Use	Chapati, bread, export, industrial